BEFORE WE GET INTO THE WEEDS...

SEO is 4 buckets.

Get all four right and you rank. Skip one and you don't. That's it.

RESEARCH FIRST



BUCKET 1

Finding keywords

What people are **actually searching for** — the foundation everything else sits on.

Root keywords · Search volume · Difficulty · Intent · Clusters · Questions · Long-tail

100% IN YOUR CONTROL



BUCKET 2

On-page SEO

Everything **on your page** — the stuff you write, structure, and publish.

Title tags · Headings · Content · Keywords · Internal links · Images & alt text · Schema

MOSTLY AUTOMATED



BUCKET 3

Technical SEO

How your site is **built and served** — speed, crawlability, infrastructure.

Sitemap.xml · Robots.txt · Site speed · Core Web Vitals · Mobile-friendly · HTTPS · Canonicals

SLOWEST, HARDEST



BUCKET 4

Off-page SEO

What the **rest of the internet** says about you — earned, not built.

Backlinks · Google reviews · Brand mentions · Local citations · Social signals · PR · Referring domains

Buckets 1 + 2 + 3 = **Claude Code handles 95%**. Bucket 4 = your reputation, earned over time.

REALITY CHECK

AI SEO is (mostly) just SEO.

Everyone's selling AI SEO courses. Here's the truth.

1 UNDER THE HOOD
Where AI pulls from

- **Google AI Overviews** → Google search results
- **ChatGPT Search** → Bing's index
- **Perplexity** → Live web + citations
- **Claude (web search)** → Live web + citations

2 80% SAME AS SEO
Already ranking? You're in.

- **Rank on Google** = AI cites you
- **Good content** = AI uses it as a source
- **Domain authority** = AI trusts you
- **E-E-A-T signals** = AI weighs them heavily

3 THE 20% THAT'S DIFFERENT
Tweaks that help AI parse

- **Clean H2 / bullets** → Easier for AI to parse
- **Direct answer in §1** → AI extracts intros
- **FAQ schema** → Cited directly in AI answers
- **Author bio + credentials** → AI weighs authority hard

THE REAL "AI SEO" Earning mentions in **training data** — Reddit, Wikipedia, major news sites. That's **backlinks + PR**, not SEO tricks.

Do traditional SEO right. You're already ranking in **ChatGPT**, **Perplexity**, and **Google AI Overviews**. No separate course needed.

THE THESIS

Two tactics. $500K+ earned.

The rest of this video is exactly how — **both covered, both scaled with Claude Code**.

1

TACTIC 1 · CONTENT ENGINE

Blog posts at scale

Target **long-tail informational keywords**. Every post builds domain authority — **lifting every other page on the site** in the rankings.

TARGET	JOB
"how to..." queries	Authority + top-of-funnel
VOLUME	**PATTERN**
15–100+ posts	1 root + cluster / post

COVERED Chapter 3 · clusters, SERP analysis, voice refs

2

TACTIC 2 · LEAD ENGINE

Service pages at scale

Target **high-intent local buyers**. Every page captures leads from "**[service] [city]**" queries — the most valuable traffic on the internet.

TARGET	JOB
"plumber Toronto" queries	Capture the lead
VOLUME	**PATTERN**
Service × city matrix	Programmatic zipper

COVERED Chapter 4 · the zipper, templates at scale

One site. **Two revenue engines.** Both run the same AI-powered workflow.

HOW GOOGLE GETS YOUR WEBSITE

SSG vs SSR vs CSR — like ordering pizza.

SSG

BEST

Pizza already made



Google is happy

SSR

SLOW

Made fresh. Wait.



Google is waiting

CSR

NOPE

Make it yourself



Google leaves

Google is hungry. Give it a ready pizza.

HERE'S WHAT GOOGLE ACTUALLY SEES

SSG, SSR, CSR — only one ranks on Google.

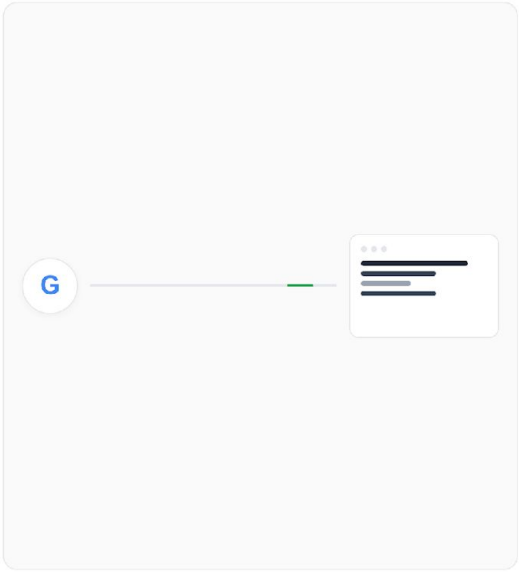
● RANKS ● RANKS POORLY ● DOESN'T RANK

SSG — STATIC SITE GENERATION

Pre-built pages

RANKS

Every page is built **once, ahead of time**. Google arrives and gets a finished HTML page — instantly.



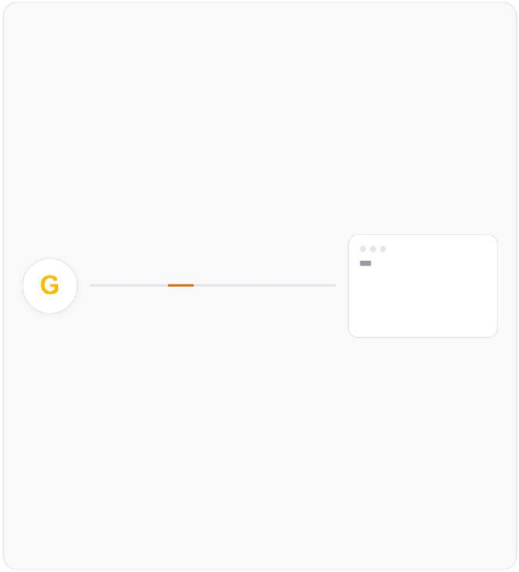
Indexed instantly ~0.1s

SSR — SERVER-SIDE RENDERING

Built on demand

RANKS POORLY

Every visit triggers a **fresh build on the server**. Google has to wait — slow pages get crawled less.



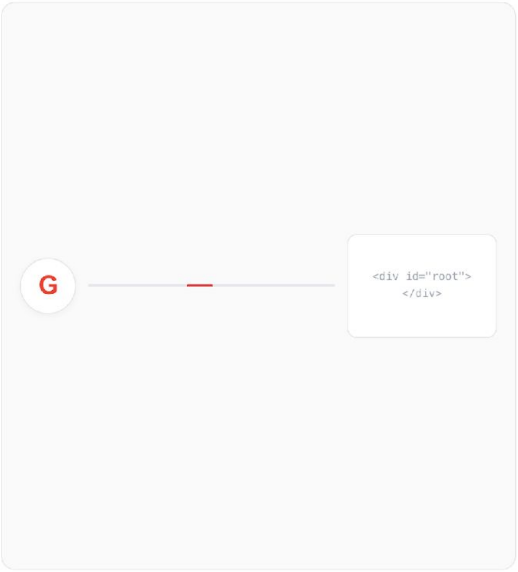
Slow = penalised 1–3s+

CSR — CLIENT-SIDE RENDERING

Built in the browser

DOESN'T RANK

The page is assembled by **JavaScript inside the visitor's browser**. Google gets an empty shell.



Nothing to index empty

That's why most **AI-built websites never rank** — they default to **CSR**. Build with **SSG**.

THE KEYWORD RESEARCH WORKFLOW

Find keywords Google rewards — then build for them.

Sr

STEP 1 — HUNT

SEMRush · Keyword Magic

FIND

1 Find keywords
Enter root keyword, then apply:
Low KD · High Volume · Informational

2 Adjacent topics
Same audience, different life stage. Rank for what they **read**, not just what they **buy**.
"best water softener 2026" · "tankless vs tank water heater" · "signs you need a new water heater"

3 Questions tab
Grab every question tied to a root keyword — cluster them onto the **same page** as FAQ content.
root: "plumbing services" · + 12 FAQ questions

4 Competitor gap
Plug in a rival, steal every keyword they rank for.

EXPORT

csv keywords.csv

HAND-OFF

CC

STEP 2 — BUILD

Claude Code · Cluster & Route

GROUP

5 Cluster by intent
Same-intent keywords = ONE page. No cannibalisation.

6 Route to page type
Informational → blog. Commercial → service page.

→ BLOG POSTS	→ SERVICE PAGES
how to unclog a drain	emergency plumber [city]
why is my tap leaking	hot water repair [city]
cost to fix a hot water…	blocked drain service

Low competition × high volume × buyer intent — the cheapest traffic on the internet.

CH 3 — BLOG POSTS AT SCALE

One blog post = 1 root keyword + keyword cluster.

Generate **hundreds** of blog posts — each targeting a whole family of related keywords. Claude Code pulls them from SEMRush or generates them itself.

plumbing.co/blog/how-to-unclog-a-drain

ONE POST · ZOOMED IN

ROOT KEYWORD **how to unclog a drain**

CLUSTER: +8

- Sr unclog kitchen sink
- Sr unclog bathroom sink
- Sr drain won't drain
- CC slow draining sink
- Sr home remedy clogged drain
- CC what dissolves hair in drain
- Sr baking soda vinegar drain
- CC snake vs drain cleaner

✓ 2,200 words · ✓ 12 H2s · ✓ FAQ × 6 · ✓ All 8 keywords ranking

× MANY POSTS

Each one targets its own cluster

16+ posts

ROOT: how to fix a leaky tap CLUSTER: dripping faucet, tap leaking at base, drip…	ROOT: water heater not working CLUSTER: no hot water, pilot light out, heater reset	ROOT: toilet keeps running CLUSTER: flapper replacement, toilet won't stop,…	ROOT: low water pressure fix CLUSTER: whole house low PSI, kitchen tap slow,…
ROOT: burst pipe emergency CLUSTER: frozen pipe, shut off main, pipe leak fix	ROOT: garbage disposal humming CLUSTER: disposal stuck, reset button, disposal not…	ROOT: tankless water heater guide CLUSTER: tankless vs tank, tankless cost, tankless…	ROOT: signs you need a new water heater CLUSTER: heater lifespan, old heater signs, water…
ROOT: why is my water brown CLUSTER: rusty water, water discoloured, brown tap…	ROOT: why is my drain smelly CLUSTER: smelly kitchen sink, drain gas smell, sewer…	ROOT: how to fix a clogged toilet CLUSTER: toilet not flushing, plunger won't work,…	ROOT: best sump pump 2026 CLUSTER: basement flooding, sump pump reviews, sump pump…
ROOT: prevent frozen pipes CLUSTER: winterize plumbing, pipe insulation, frozen pipe…	ROOT: water softener vs filter CLUSTER: hard water signs, water softener cost, water…	ROOT: noisy pipes banging CLUSTER: water hammer, pipes knocking, noisy plumbing	ROOT: how to bleed a radiator CLUSTER: cold radiator fix, bleed valve, radiator air

AND 100S MORE — ONE CLUSTER PER KEYWORD

One keyword per page is amateur. **One cluster per page** is how you dominate a niche.

CHAPTER 3 — BLOG POSTS AT SCALE

Steal the SERP.

Whatever ranks in the top 3 is what Google wants. Match the format. Hit the average.

Google how to unclog a drain

1

thespruce.com › home-repair

8 Ways to Unclog a Drain (Without Calling a Plumber)

A step-by-step guide with household items, chemical-free methods, and when to call a pro...

2,240	12	9	FAQ
WORDS	H2S	IMAGES	SCHEMA

2

familyhandyman.com › plumbing

How to Unclog a Drain: 6 Proven Methods That Actually Work

From baking soda tricks to snake tools — the exact steps pros use when a drain won't clear...

1,860	9	6	Video
WORDS	H2S	IMAGES	EMBED

3

bobvila.com › how-to

How to Unclog a Drain the Right Way — A Complete Guide

Diagnose, unclog, and prevent blockages in kitchen sinks, showers, and bathtubs...

2,420	15	11	FAQ
WORDS	H2S	IMAGES	SCHEMA

EXTRACT & AVERAGE THE PATTERN

YOUR NEW POST

Match the format. Hit the average.

Same H2 structure, average word count, average image count, FAQ schema — right in the sweet spot Google rewards.

2,173≈	12≈	9≈	FAQ✓
WORDS	H2S	IMAGES	SCHEMA

If it's ranking top 3, it's what Google wants. **Match the format. Hit the average.**

CH 3 — THE ANTI-SLOP KIT

Sound like you, not ~~AI~~.

Feed Claude your voice, stats, and stories — or get the same boring post as everyone else using ChatGPT.

voice.md
Tone, vocabulary, sentence rhythm.
"straight up" "heads up"

stats.md
Your real numbers. No guesses.
3,400 drains since 2014

stories.md
Anecdotes from the field.
The 2am toilet flood

opinions.md
Hot takes. What most pros get wrong.
Drano = pipe killer

humour.md
Jokes, analogies, wink lines.
plumbing dad-jokes

CLAUDE CODE READS THESE EVERY TIME IT WRITES

WITHOUT REFS **Generic AI slop**

How to Unclog a Drain

Clogged drains are a common household issue that can cause significant inconvenience. There are several methods you can use to address this problem.

It is important to identify the cause of the clog before attempting to resolve it. Common causes include hair, grease, and food particles.

If the clog persists, it may be necessary to contact a professional plumber for assistance.

● Reads like a textbook

Avg. dwell: 14s ↓

WITH REFS **Sounds like a human**

How to Unclog a Drain (Without Calling Me at 2am)

Heads up — that gurgling noise? Your drain isn't haunted. It's just mad at you.

Here's the thing. I've pulled 3,400 nasty surprises out of Vancouver drains since 2014 — hair, grease, one wedding ring, and once, I swear on my toolbox, a whole hot dog. Honestly? 80% of the calls I get, you could've solved yourself before the water hit your socks.

Put the Drano down. That stuff eats pipes the way my dog eats leftovers — fast, reckless, and I'm the one paying for it later.

Let me save you the $180 service call.

● voice ● stats ● stories ● opinions ● humour

Avg. dwell: 2m 40s ↑

Nobody finishes a dry, boring post. Personality keeps readers on the page — and Google rewards the ones that stay.

TWO PAGE TYPES, TWO JOBS

Service pages catch. Blog posts raise the tide.

SERVICE PAGE
Capture the lead

CONVERT

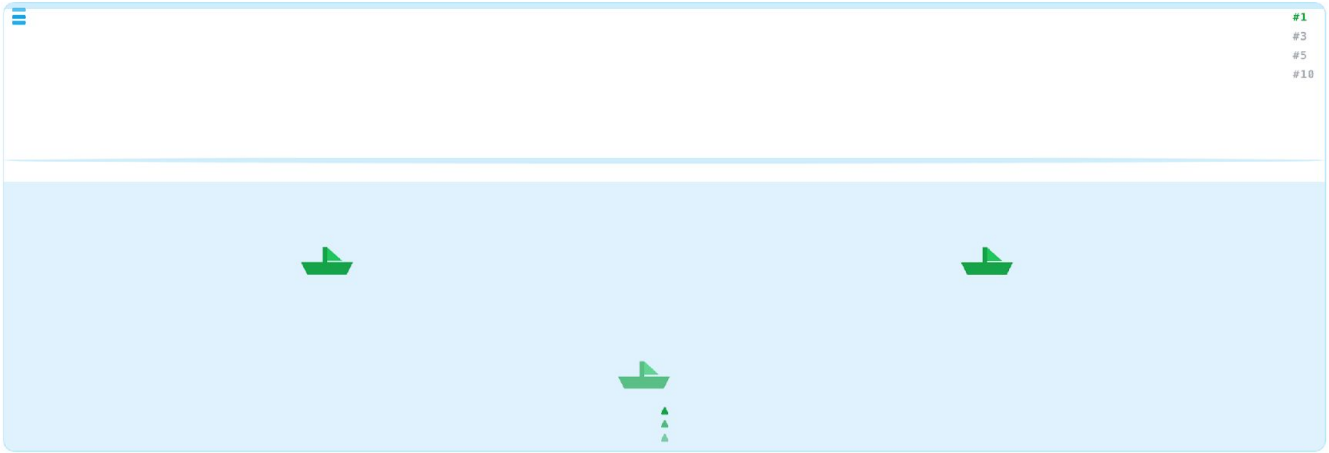
Ranks for buyers ready to call. One job: **get the form filled.**

BLOG POST
Build the authority

TRUST

Blog posts do 4 things for SEO:

1. Build **topical authority** in your niche.
2. Pass **link equity** to service pages via internal links.
3. Capture **long-tail traffic** that funnels to leads.
4. Signal to Google your site is **active & trusted**.



Blog posts ↓
Fill the domain with trust signals

Service pages ↑
Rise together in Google rankings

Every blog post **raises domain authority** — and that rising tide lifts every service page on Google.

REALITY CHECK

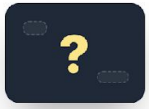
SEO is a black box. Except this part.

Nobody — not SEMRush, not Ahrefs, not even Google's own employees — knows the full algorithm. But Google's **business model is public**, and it tells you exactly what to optimise for.

1 WHAT NOBODY KNOWS

The algorithm

Google has **200+ rumoured ranking signals** — never published, and they never will be. SEO tools reverse-engineer. Their scores are **educated guesses**.



- **2024 Google leak** — 14,000 attributes exposed
- SEMRush, Ahrefs, Moz all **estimate**
- Public statements are often **misleading**

2 WHAT EXPERTS AGREE ON

Likely signals

Every serious SEO tool converges on roughly the same list — most of them are **proxies for the same thing**: is this page actually useful?

Content quality & depth · Dwell time · Bounce rate
Scroll depth · Click-through rate · Backlink quality
Page speed · Mobile UX · E-E-A-T signals · Topical authority

All proxies for: did this page answer the question, and did the user stop searching?

3 WHAT ACTUALLY DRIVES IT

Help Google win

Google's only real goal: **keep users on Google**. That's the only way they sell ads. Everything in the algorithm exists to serve that one goal.

- $ Google makes money from **ads**.
- → Ads need **user attention**.
- → Attention needs **relevant results**.
- ★ **Be the result users don't need to search past.**

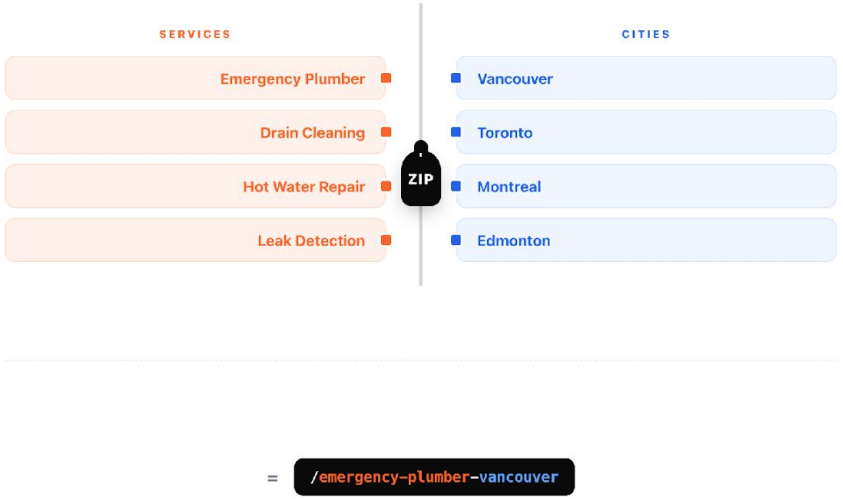
Help Google keep its users → Google keeps sending you more.

Every ranking factor is Google trying to guess **one thing**: **did this page answer the question?**

PROGRAMMATIC SEO FOR SERVICE BUSINESSES

Service pages are a zipper.

Service on one side. **City** on the other. Zip them together.



ONE TEMPLATE → MANY PAGES

Every combination is a ranking page

16 pages

Emergency Plumber × Vancouver	Emergency Plumber × Toronto	Emergency Plumber × Montreal	Emergency Plumber × Edmonton
Drain Cleaning × Vancouver	Drain Cleaning × Toronto	Drain Cleaning × Montreal	Drain Cleaning × Edmonton
Hot Water Repair × Vancouver	Hot Water Repair × Toronto	Hot Water Repair × Montreal	Hot Water Repair × Edmonton
Leak Detection × Vancouver	Leak Detection × Toronto	Leak Detection × Montreal	Leak Detection × Edmonton

Same template. **One build.** Dozens of ranking pages.

4 services × 4 cities = 16 pages

THE COMPREHENSIVE ON-PAGE SEO CHECKLIST

On-page SEO — do these on every page.

15 categories · 80+ items · the complete on-page SEO spec for blog posts and service pages. Technical SEO (sitemaps, robots.txt, Core Web Vitals) is covered separately.

Save this as `on-page-seo.md` — every page-generation skill reads it before generating any page.

1 HEAD & METADATA — What Google indexes first

- [ ] **Title tag** — 50–60 chars, primary keyword near the start.
- [ ] **Meta description** — 150–160 chars, keyword + benefit + soft CTA.
- [ ] **Canonical URL** — self-referencing, prevents duplicates.
- [ ] **Open Graph** — `og:title`, `og:description`, `og:image` (1200×630), `og:url`, `og:type`.
- [ ] **Twitter Card** — `summary_large_image`, title, description, image.
- [ ] **Language** attribute on `<html>` (e.g. `lang="en"`).
- [ ] **Viewport meta** tag for responsive rendering.
- [ ] **Favicon** + `apple-touch-icon`.
- [ ] **Charset meta** — `<meta charset="utf-8">`.

2 URL STRUCTURE — Clean, readable, keyword-forward

- [ ] **Short slug** — under 60 chars.
- [ ] **Primary keyword** in the slug.
- [ ] **Hyphens** only — never underscores.
- [ ] **Lowercase** only.
- [ ] **No stop words** ("a", "an", "the") unless necessary.
- [ ] **Logical hierarchy** — `/services/{slug}`, `/blog/{slug}`.

3 HEADINGS — Structure for skimmers & bots

- [ ] **Exactly one H1** per page, contains primary keyword.
- [ ] **Logical H2 → H3** hierarchy — never skip levels.
- [ ] **H2s** use supporting keywords + questions from the cluster.
- [ ] **No keyword stuffing** — write naturally.

4 COPY & BODY — Answer the query, fast

- [ ] **Primary keyword** in the first 100 words.
- [ ] **Direct answer** to the query in the first paragraph.
- [ ] **Length** matches SERP average (within 20% of top-3).
- [ ] **Short paragraphs** (2–4 sentences).
- [ ] **Readability** — 8th–10th grade level.
- [ ] **Active voice** preferred.
- [ ] **Bold key phrases** — sparingly.
- [ ] **Bullets & numbered lists** where appropriate.

5 FAQ SECTION — Every blog post

- [ ] **4–6 questions** from SEMRush Questions tab + "People Also Ask".
- [ ] **Direct answers** — 2–4 sentences each.
- [ ] **FAQ schema** (JSON-LD) applied.

6 IMAGES — Every image is a ranking signal

- [ ] **Alt text** describing image + keyword where natural.
- [ ] **Filenames** — descriptive, hyphens, e.g. `emergency-plumber-toronto.webp`.
- [ ] **WebP**, compressed under 200 KB.
- [ ] **Width/height** attributes specified — prevents CLS.
- [ ] **Lazy loading** (`loading="lazy"`) for below-fold.
- [ ] **Responsive `srcset`** where needed.
- [ ] **Featured/hero image** for social sharing.

7 INTERNAL LINKS — Pass authority across the site

- [ ] **3–5 internal links** per post.
- [ ] Link to **related blog posts** & **relevant service pages**.
- [ ] **Descriptive anchor text** — never "click here" or "read more".
- [ ] **Contextually placed** in body copy.
- [ ] **Breadcrumbs** on every page.

8 EXTERNAL LINKS — Cite authority, don't hoard it

- [ ] **2–3 external links** to authoritative sources (.gov, .edu, major industry).
- [ ] **Relevant** to the topic.
- [ ] Open in **new tab** with `rel="noopener"`.
- [ ] `rel="nofollow"` for sponsored links.

9 SCHEMA MARKUP — JSON-LD in `<head>`

- [ ] **Article** schema on blog posts.
- [ ] **LocalBusiness** schema — most specific subtype (Plumber, Dentist…).
- [ ] **Service** schema on service pages.
- [ ] **FAQ** schema wherever FAQ section exists.
- [ ] **BreadcrumbList** schema on every page.
- [ ] **Organization** schema site-wide.
- [ ] **Author/Person** schema for bylines.

10 E-E-A-T SIGNALS — Experience · Expertise · Authority · Trust

- [ ] **Author byline** with name on every blog post.
- [ ] **Author bio** with credentials (years, qualifications).
- [ ] Link to **author's dedicated page**.
- [ ] **Published date** displayed.
- [ ] **"Last updated" date** when refreshed.
- [ ] **Real stories, numbers, opinions** from the business voice file.
- [ ] **Cite authoritative sources.**
- [ ] **About page** with full company credentials.
- [ ] **Contact page** — real address, phone, hours.

11 ACCESSIBILITY — A11y signals = SEO signals

- [ ] **Semantic HTML5** — `<header>`, `<nav>`, `<main>`, `<article>`, `<footer>`.
- [ ] **ARIA labels** on interactive elements where needed.
- [ ] **Color contrast** meets WCAG AA (4.5:1 body text).
- [ ] **Focus indicators** visible on interactive elements.
- [ ] **Alt text** on all images (empty `alt=""` for decorative).
- [ ] **Descriptive link text.**
- [ ] **Skip-to-content** link for keyboard users.

12 MOBILE & RESPONSIVE — Mobile-first indexing

- [ ] **Responsive layout** (Tailwind handles this).
- [ ] **Touch targets** minimum 48×48 px.
- [ ] **Body font** minimum 16 px.
- [ ] **No horizontal scroll** at any viewport.
- [ ] **No intrusive interstitials.**

13 SOCIAL PREVIEW — Shareable card

- [ ] **OG image** optimized — 1200×630, under 1 MB.
- [ ] **Twitter Card image** — 1200×600.
- [ ] **Compelling `og:description`** — different from meta if valuable.

14 CONVERSION ELEMENTS — Capture the lead

SERVICE PAGES ONLY

- [ ] **Primary CTA** above the fold.
- [ ] **Phone number** with click-to-call (`tel:`).
- [ ] **Multiple CTA placements** throughout the page.
- [ ] **Trust signals** — reviews, ratings, licenses, years.
- [ ] **Testimonials** with names (photos where possible).
- [ ] **Service-area coverage** listed.
- [ ] **Business hours** displayed.
- [ ] **Physical address** with embedded map.

15 LONG-FORM CONTENT — 1500+ word posts

1500+ WORDS

- [ ] **Table of contents** with anchor links at the top.
- [ ] **Jump links** for each H2.
- [ ] **Back-to-top** button.

Point Claude Code at `on-page-seo.md`, then say **"generate a blog post about X"** — it will satisfy every item on this list automatically. That's the whole point.

80+
ITEMS · 15 CATEGORIES

Technical SEO — 3 things. Claude handles the rest.

Technical SEO used to mean a checklist of 50 things. Now it's three steps — and AI does the heavy lifting.

1 SITEMAP.XML
A list of every page

A map of your site for Google. Tells the crawler every URL worth indexing — so nothing gets missed.

```
<urlset>
  <url>
    <loc>example.com/</loc>
  </url>
  <url>
    <loc>/blog/how-to-unclog…</loc>
  </url>
  <url>
    <loc>/services/emergency…</loc>
  </url>
</urlset>
```

DO THIS Submit it once to **Google Search Console**. Done.

2 ROBOTS.TXT
The crawler's rulebook

Tells bots where they can and can't go. Points them to your sitemap. One tiny file, site-wide.

```
# robots.txt
User-agent: *
Allow: /
Disallow: /admin

Sitemap: example.com/sitemap.xml
```

DO THIS Claude generates it. You **don't touch it again**.

3 GOOGLE LIGHTHOUSE
Your performance report

Scores your site on speed, SEO, accessibility, best practices. Run it → paste the report to Claude → it fixes everything.



DO THIS **Copy report → paste to Claude.** It fixes images, fonts, CSS blocking.

Submit the **sitemap**, ship the **robots.txt**, paste the **Lighthouse report**. That's technical SEO in 2026.

THE WRAP-UP — AUTOMATE THE WHOLE THING

Wrap it all in a Claude Code skill.

Two skills. Two slash commands. **One prompt = one fully optimized page** that passes every item on the SEO checklist.

```
$ /blog "how to unclog a drain"
```

MD

SKILL · CONTENT ENGINE

write-blog-post.md

READS

`on-page-seo.md` `voice.md` `stats.md` `stories.md` `opinions.md` `humour.md`

RUNS

1. Pull **keyword cluster** from SEMRush export
2. **SERP analysis** — average the top 3
3. Inject **voice + stats + stories**
4. Build **FAQ** from People Also Ask
5. Verify every **on-page-seo.md** item

OUT `/content/blog/[slug].mdx` — frontmatter, FAQ, Article + FAQ schema

```
$ /service emergency-plumber toronto
```

MD

SKILL · LEAD ENGINE

write-service-page.md

READS

`on-page-seo.md` `voice.md` `business.ts` `conversion-template.md`

RUNS

1. Look up **service × city** pair from the zipper
2. Pull **local business data** (phone, address, hours)
3. Fill **conversion template** — CTA, trust, testimonials
4. Generate **LocalBusiness + Service schema**
5. Verify every **on-page-seo.md** item

OUT `/content/services/[slug].mdx` — CTA, form, LocalBusiness schema

Run `/blog` or `/service`. Claude reads the refs, runs the workflow, ships a fully-optimized page. **Every time.**

BUCKET 3 — OFF-PAGE SEO

Off-page SEO — easier to tank than to help.

Off-page SEO is **basically backlinks**. Real gains take months of careful outreach — and one bad batch can undo a year of work. Skip it unless you really have to.

1 OUTREACH — Broken-link swap — LEGIT

Find a **broken link** on someone's site that used to point to a resource like yours. Email them: "your link is dead — here's mine."

HOW

SEMRush → `Backlink Analytics` → filter for **broken** links on sites in your niche.

2 CONTRIBUTION — Guest posts — LEGIT

Write a **real article** for a site in your niche. Your byline or bio gets to link back to you. Slow, but safe.

HOW

Google `"[your industry] + guest post"`. Pitch the ones with active blogs.

3 EARNED MEDIA — HARO / Connectively — LEGIT · FREE

Journalists post **queries** looking for expert sources. Reply fast, get quoted — and get a byline link from a real publication.

HOW

Subscribe to the daily emails. Answer queries in your niche **within 1–2 hours**. Keep pitches tight.

4 PAID PLACEMENT — Quality paid links — EXPERT ONLY

Real publishers. Real editorial. **Actually works** if you know who to pay. **Blows up your site** if you don't.

HOW

Vet the domain yourself. Check traffic, DR, and **who else** links from it. If it looks spammy, walk.

THE REAL SHORTCUT

Make something good enough that it earns links on its own.

This video is free, long, and well-researched — **people will link to it because it's useful**. That's the entire game. No outreach, no PBNs, no begging journalists.

THE TRAP · THIS KILLS SITES

Avoid PBNs & link farms at all costs.

Most cheap "SEO experts" on Upwork use **Private Blog Networks** — thousands of fake sites linking to each other. Google spots the pattern and **tanks your rankings**. Recovery takes months. Sometimes never.

RED FLAGS

- ✕ "$50 for 100 DR-50 backlinks"
- ✕ "Instant links, no waiting"
- ✕ "Ranks in 7 days guaranteed"
- ✕ Bulk packages on Fiverr

My take: nail buckets 1 + 2, ignore bucket 3. On-page + technical SEO alone will rank you for **95% of niches**. Backlinks come **naturally** when your content is actually good.

AFTER YOU SHIP — YOUR PUNCH LIST

Four things to do on launch day.

You've got a site. Now set up the compounding wins — the stuff that multiplies your traffic for **zero extra content**.

1 MANDATORY · LOCAL

GOOGLE BUSINESS PROFILE

Claim your local listing

If you're a **local service business**, this is non-negotiable. Shows up in Google Maps + the local 3-pack — massive free traffic.

DO THIS

Claim. Verify address. Fill every field. Ask customers for **reviews**.

2 FREE

GOOGLE SEARCH CONSOLE

Track impressions & rankings

Google tells you exactly **which keywords** you rank for, how often you're shown, and what gets clicked.

DO THIS

Verify domain. Submit **sitemap.xml**. Request indexing on key pages.

3 FREE

GOOGLE ANALYTICS (GA4)

Track visitors & behaviour

See which pages get traffic, where visitors come from, how long they stay, and **what they do next**.

DO THIS

Install the GA4 snippet. Set **conversion events** (form submit, phone tap).

4 ONGOING

CRO — SPLIT TESTING

Test your landing pages

Same traffic, higher conversion = more leads. Test **one thing at a time** — headline, CTA, hero image — find the winner, run with it.

DO THIS

Start with the **hero headline**. Swap quarterly. Keep the winner.

!

DON'T DO THIS

Don't dump 1,000 blog posts on day one.

Google sees the spam pattern and **deprioritises your whole site**. Drip them out. Slow and steady wins this game.

100/day → 2–5/week

Ship it → set up these four → **drip content weekly**. In 3 months you'll have real data. In 12, real traffic.